

Question:

A 60-year-old woman is brought to the emergency department because of altered mental status for 2 hours. She and her husband were at the grocery store when she suddenly could not remember why she was there or how she got there. She has not had any head trauma. She has a history of depression and migraines. She does not smoke and drinks a glass of wine each night with dinner. She takes fluoxetine daily. She appears distressed and anxious. Her vital signs are within normal limits. She is fully alert and oriented to self and place but not to time. Every few minutes she asks how she got to the emergency department. She is able to follow commands and sustain attention. She recalls 3/3 objects immediately and recalls 0/3 objects at 5 minutes. The remainder of the neurological exam shows no abnormalities.

Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Transient global amnesia
- B. Depersonalization/derealization disorder
- C. Seizure
- D. Migraine

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms suggest a sudden onset of impaired consciousness or awareness of one's self or the world, which does not have a recognized cause, particularly her acute onset of disorientation to time and constant recall of how she arrived at the emergency department </think><answer> Transient global amnesia </answer>

